Blake Robert Mills

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EDUCATION

Columbia University **New York, NY**
Bachelor of Arts in Political Science-Statistics Degree Awarded May 2023

- GPA: 3.96
- Cum Laude

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

General Services Administration/United States Department of Defense **New York, NY (Remote)**
Digital Corp Fellow July 2023 - Present

Center for an Urban Future **New York, NY**
Research Associate January 2023 - May 2023

- Conduct background research and draft memos on issues related to public policy to guide new and existing research projects
- Pull, clean, and analyze structured and unstructured data to provide support for ongoing research
- Provide data visualization for reports and social media content generated in R
- Contribute to the report production process by drafting text, proof-reading, fact-checking, and editing

What Works Cities-Results for America **Washington, DC**
Certification Intern June 2022 - December 2022

- Reviewed 50+ city's data policies, practices, and analyses to provide a best practices guide for data-smart cities
- Analyzed various documents and policies from different cities to determine whether they meet specific criteria for the What Works Cities' City of Excellence designation
- Communicated with city officials about how to better steward, manage, organize, and communicate data with public stakeholders
- Supported the expansion of city data certification to include Canadian and Latin American cities
- Reviewed individual city performance goals to determine if data-driven policies and research were being utilized to further city initiatives

Urban Institute **Washington, DC**
Nonprofits and Philanthropies Data Science Intern June 2022 - August 2022

- Independently led the development and implementation of a web-scraping R package to gather data from thousands of nonprofit and philanthropy websites
- Created an interactive map to plot the locations of nonprofits and philanthropies in the United States to study their relationship with local health and social outcomes
- Worked collaboratively to conduct analyses regarding the reflectiveness of nonprofit boards on the communities that they serve in terms of race, gender, and income
- Worked cross-functionally with several teams to support ad hoc research projects analyzing the effects of increased social capital on community health outcomes

Two Rivers Public Health Department **Kearney, NE (Remote)**
Data Analyst and Researcher May 2020 - July 2022

- Performed qualitative and quantitative analyses regarding access to healthcare in R and Stata
- Generated and published visualizations in R and Tableau for technical and non-technical audiences
- Entered, cleaned, and managed large quantities of data in R and Excel while working with set privacy guidelines
- Researched the spread and trends of COVID-19 within low-income and minority communities

- Defined departmental policies for data collection, ethics, and integrity and communicated them to the public

Urban Green Council **New York, NY**
Research Intern September 2021 - May 2022

- Examined raw data and conducted analyses to support ongoing reports and novel research on urban sustainability
- Utilized open data sources from New York and other entities to monitor trends in urban energy use
- Modeled scenarios regarding the reduction of building emissions and the electrification of cities
- Presented results of analyses to guide public policy decisions regarding sustainability in urban settings
- Provided visualizations for data storytelling regarding energy use in urban environments during the pandemic

Columbia University, Department of Statistics **New York, NY**
Public Interest Technology-Data Science Corps Intern June 2021 - August 2021

- Parsed PDF documents in R and Python to extract wide scope of community health data and outcomes of New York City communities
- Conducted analyses, communicated research, and prepared visualizations for public policy presentations
- Researched independently and with small teams to provide project managers with needed data and analyses

RESEARCH & PROJECTS

How a Global Pandemic Shifted NYC's Energy Use **New York, NY**
Report with Urban Green Council April 2022

- Research report using open data from New York City to analyze how multifamily housing and offices changed their electricity consumption throughout the course of the COVID-19 pandemic
- Analyzed the relationship between income and location on shifting energy consumption in New York City

{MetBrewer} **New York, NY**
R Package January 2022

- Color palettes for data visualization based around artwork at the Metropolitan Museum of Art in New York
- Over 50 color palettes were created, with many being colorblind-friendy and more accessible
- Currently over 13,000 downloads and used in several scientific publications

Take it to Twitter: Social Media Analysis of Members of Congress **New York, NY**
Medium August 2021

- Conducted sentiment analysis on over one million tweets from members of Congress to examine policy views
- Used natural language processing methods in R to monitor the frequency of policy issue mentions
- Provided a guided tutorial for running text cleaning and sentiment analysis in R

First One-Hundred Days COVID-19 Report **Kearney, NE**
In collaboration with Dr. Aravind Menon, Two Rivers Public Health Department August 2020

- Government report for public consumption regarding the spread of COVID-19 in the district's jurisdiction
- Conducted qualitative and quantitative analysis to examine what demographics were affected by COVID-19
- Provided transparency of data collection and storage methods to generate public assurance

SKILLS

Coding Languages: R (Advanced), Excel (Intermediate), Tableau (Intermediate), Python (Beginner), SQL (Beginner)
R Packages and Skills: {ggplot2}, {tidyverse}, {shiny}, {lubridate}, {MASS}, package development
Analysis Skills: linear and logistic regression, random forests, data wrangling, data visualization, machine learning, text analytics, natural language processing, STM and LDA models, Twitter analytics, geospatial analysis, geospatial mapping